

Arrays

6.1 What is an Array?

In a scripting language an array is a list that includes some objects that are maintained in a certain structural order. The properties of an array are identified by this order that indicates the position of those objects in the structure of the script.

To make it simpler, we can say that an Array is a container of some values or it is a structure of various data types. Here the contents, i.e. data, are more important than the container, i.e. the array.

Say, in a bookshelf we usually organize our books according to the subject or category. We usually keep apart science books from literature. So, each rack of this shelf includes books that are categorically different from the other types of books. At the same time they share a common quality, i.e., they are all books. If we compare these different types of book with different types of data, then we can compare the bookshelf to an array. Here the contents, i.e. books, are the most important thing to us. Similarly the data are also the most significant item in an array. The significance of the array (like the bookshelf) is that it can manage the data. Another important point with arrays is that we can form or structure the arrays as per our need.

The elements of an array possess various data types such as number, strings, dates, objects etc.

Here we have an example of an array of the first decade of this century:

```
var myArr:Array = new Array();  
myArr[0] = "2000";  
myArr[1] = "2001";  
myArr[2] = "2002";  
myArr[3] = "2003";  
myArr[4] = "2004";  
myArr[5] = "2005";  
myArr[6] = "2006";
```